Trip Experience Survey: a template for study teams

A short, anonymous survey to ask people what makes getting to appointments and research visits hard. It was used in a 2026 pilot in the Boston area, alongside the Route to Research Checklist. Copy it into any form tool, replace the text in [brackets], and remove questions you don't need. Every question is optional.

Before you share it

- Don't collect names, email addresses or sign-ins. In Google Forms: Settings > Responses > Collect email addresses: Do not collect; Limit to 1 response: off.
- Don't ask for diagnoses or medical details. Ask people not to put names or identifying details in the text boxes.
- Report results only as counts and themes. Quote people only if they said Yes to question 13.
- Test the form with a screen reader before sharing it (for example, Narrator on Windows or VoiceOver on a phone).

Form description

[Site or study name] wants to make it easier for everyone to get to our visits, including people with disabilities. This 3-minute form is anonymous: please don't include your name or health details. Answers will be summarized only in aggregate. Everyone is welcome to answer, with or without a disability. All questions are optional.

Questions (all optional)

1. Which of these describe you? (Checkboxes)

- I have a disability
- I don't have a disability
- I am a family member or caregiver of someone with a disability
- Parent or caregiver of a young child
- I work in healthcare or research
- Other
- Prefer not to say

2. When you travel to appointments, do you use or bring any of these? (Checkboxes)

- Manual wheelchair
- Power wheelchair or scooter
- Walker or rollator
- Cane or crutches
- White cane or guide dog
- Hearing aids or other hearing support
- Service animal
- Someone who helps me
- Stroller
- None of these
- Prefer not to say

3. If you have a disability, which types? (Checkboxes)

- Mobility
- Blind or low vision
- Deaf or hard of hearing
- Chronic illness, fatigue or pain
- Intellectual or developmental
- Mental health
- Speech or communication
- Temporary injury or condition
- Other
- Prefer not to say

4. Do any of these also make getting to appointments harder for you? (Checkboxes)

- Low income or cost of travel
- No car
- I can't drive
- Living outside a city or far from transit
- Older age
- English is not my first language
- Caring for children or others
- None of these
- Prefer not to say

5. How important is each of these to you? (Columns: Essential / Helpful / Not needed / Not sure) (Grid)

- Transit stop: elevator at this entrance, and a sign to the accessible entrance
- Distance and rest: seats along the way, shade or shelter
- Rest and restrooms: a place to sit or lie down, a restroom nearby
- Surface: brick, cracks, gaps, tree roots, ice, puddles
- Crossings: curb ramps, warning strips, signals that beep or talk, enough time to cross
- Drop-off: loading zone for wheelchair vans, accessible parking near the door
- Entrance: automatic door, reachable button, signs to the accessible door
- Inside: distance to the desk, desk height, elevator, restroom, seating
- Senses: lighting, glare, noise, smoke, smells
- The day itself: construction detours, weather, ride pickup times
- Cost: fares, parking and rides paid back
- Ride booked and paid for by the study
- Companion: someone can come along, and their travel is covered
- Remote or home visits: by phone, video or at home when possible

6. What is missing from this list? (Paragraph)

7. Have you ever missed, cancelled or turned down a medical appointment or a research study because getting there was too hard? (Multiple choice)

- Yes, a medical appointment

- Yes, a research study
- Yes, both
- No
- Not sure

8. If yes, what made it too hard? (Checkboxes)

- Transit (no elevator, elevator out of service, no accessible stop)
- Distance or nowhere to rest
- Sidewalks, surfaces or curb ramps
- Drop-off or parking
- The building entrance or doors
- Inside the building
- Weather (snow, ice, heat)
- Ride timing (paratransit, van or ride pickup)
- Cost of travel or parking
- Fatigue or pain: the trip itself was too much
- No one to go with me
- Other

9. What one change would help you most when getting to an appointment? (Paragraph)

10. If [site or study name] checked the route to its visits and fixed the problems it found, would you be more likely to take part in a study here? (Multiple choice)

- Much more likely
- Somewhat more likely
- No difference
- Not sure

11. Which state (or country, if outside the US) do you live in? (Short answer)

12. How did you hear about this form? (Multiple choice)

- [List the places you shared it]
- Other

13. May short, anonymous quotes from your written answers be used in reports? Nothing that could identify you will be included. (Multiple choice)

- Yes
- No

Confirmation message

Thank you. Your answers are anonymous and will only be reported in summary form.

Adapted from the form used in an independent project by Uri Kartoun, DBbun LLC (dbbun.com), entered in the NIH challenge on including people with disabilities in clinical research. Not NIH-funded. Prepared with AI assistance (Claude). Free to use and adapt with credit (CC BY 4.0): github.com/DBbun/route-to-research-checklist. Version 1, November 3, 2026.